6.5.2 Key pioneers and notable drone models

Fifth-generation UAVs have been pioneered by global aerospace leaders who have integrated advanced AI, stealth, and quantum technologies into next-generation drone systems. These models exemplify the fusion of autonomy, intelligence, and strategic design, setting new standards for aerial innovation.

Table 6.2 summarizes the leading fifth-generation UAV models developed across the globe, highlighting their technological innovations, operational roles, and strategic contributions. These drones collectively represent the next stage in aerial warfare, combining stealth, AI-based autonomy, advanced avionics, and networked intelligence to achieve superior situational awareness and mission adaptability. From India's AMCA to Turkey's Kaan and Russia's S-70 Okhotnik, these systems illustrate how nations are transitioning toward AI-driven, stealth-capable unmanned combat platforms designed for both independent and cooperative missions.